Nevatch

Nevatch is a VPN you run yourself, so friends and family in a censored country can use the free internet through your connection.

Run **Nevatch Server** on a PC at home for your friends, or for yourself on a VPS you rent or buy, with Docker. Install the **Nevatch** app on Windows or Android and click **Connect**. No accounts, no subscriptions, nothing to pay.

Nevatch is built on **Xray-core** (VLESS + Reality), a proven tool against censorship. Nevatch makes it simple to use.

This guide, the changelog, and the Android and Docker guides are also in the `docs` folder as PDFs.

What you need

- A Windows PC that stays on (or a Linux server, see Advanced).
- Access to your home router's settings (usually a web page like http://192.168.1.1).
- That's all. Nothing else to install.

Step 1: Download

Go to the **Releases** page and download:

- `Nevatch-Server-<version>.exe` : for you (the server).
- `Nevatch-<version>.exe` : for your friends (the app).
- `Nevatch-Android-<version>.apk` : the same app for your friends' Android phones.

Step 2: Start the server

1. Double-click `Nevatch-Server-<version>.exe` .
    - Windows may say "*Windows protected your PC*". Click **More info** → **Run anyway**.
    - If Windows Firewall asks, click **Allow**.
2. It asks if the server's web page needs a password. Choose **Open** if only you use this PC.
3. Click **Start server**. The shield turns green.

Closing the window keeps the server running (look for the shield next to the clock).

Step 3: Open the door in your router

Your friends need a way in. In your router's settings, find **Port forwarding** (sometimes called *Virtual server* or *NAT*) and add a rule:

Setting	Value
Port	**443**

Setting	Value
Protocol	**TCP**
Send to	this PC (the server shows its address under *Settings* → *Setup checklist*)

Every router looks different. Search the web for "port forwarding" plus your router's brand if you can't find it.

Step 4: Add a friend

1. In the server, go to **People**.
2. Type your friend's name and click **Add person**.
3. Click **Copy key**.
4. Send your friend the `Nevatch-<version>.exe` file and the **key** (Telegram works well).

Step 5: Your friend connects

Send your friend these steps:

1. Open `Nevatch-<version>.exe`. If Windows warns you, click **More info** → **Run anyway**.
2. Click **Install**.
3. Click **Add key** and paste the key.
4. Click **Connect**. The shield turns green. Done!

On an Android phone? Install `Nevatch-Android-<version>.apk` and paste the key, or scan it: on the PC, Nevatch's *Servers* page has **Use on phone**, which shows the key as a QR code. On an iPhone, use the free app **Streisand** (it can scan the same QR code).

Problems?

My friend can't connect.

- Check the server says *Running*.
- Check the port forwarding rule (Step 3).
- Compare the internet address on your router's status page with whatismyip.com. If they're different, your provider shares one address between many homes (*CGNAT*). Ask them for a *public IPv4 address*.

It worked, but stopped after a few days. Your home's internet address probably changed. Get a free name at DuckDNS, put it in *Settings* → *Public address*, and send everyone their key again. After that, address changes don't matter.

An antivirus deleted the app. This happens with VPN apps. Restore it from the antivirus's quarantine and mark it as safe.

Something else. Your friend clicks **Log** → **Copy log** in the app and sends you the text.

Good to know

- **Only give keys to people you trust.** What they do online looks like it comes from your home.
- **Remove** cuts someone off. **Disable** pauses them.
- **Updates** reach your friends' apps by themselves.
- **Less lag:** connect the server PC with a network cable instead of Wi-Fi.
- **Speed limit** per person is in *Settings* → *Server settings*.
- **Russian sites** (banks, Gosuslugi) skip the VPN, so they keep working.
- **Private:** Nevatch keeps no record of which websites anyone visits. VPN users can't reach your home network, can't torrent, and can't send spam.

Advanced

▶ **Run the server with Docker (Linux, NAS or VPS)**
▶ **Run the server on Ubuntu without Docker**
▶ **Build from source**

Credits and license

- Xray-core (MPL-2.0) does the VPN work.
- Node.js (MIT) runs the server and is packed inside the Windows server.
- Wintun provides the network adapter on Windows.

Nevatch is released under the MIT License.